RDM — Design History File

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This is RDM's own DHF: the record RDM keeps about itself, checked by RDM's own gates. Every change lands through a pull request that someone other than its author approves, with the gates green. How RDM works is in the docs (`docs/about/how-rdm-works.md`); why RDM reads a spec as Gherkin rather than authoring one is ADR 0002 (`decisions/`).

RDM is not a medical device, so this DHF holds the **design-controls slice** (requirements, verification, validation, traceability, tool risks), not the full IEC 62304 lifecycle set (a complete risk management file, SOUP register, maintenance and problem-resolution plans, …). `rdm gap 62304_2015_class_b` over these documents reports those items as missing, as expected.

1 What the record is

Part	Where	What it holds
The spec	`.pi/spec/<context>/` (outside `dhf/`; `.pi/plan/` links the slices)	RDM's requirements and user needs, written the Löyly way: each accepted scenario of `spec.feature`, stamped `@item-NN-SSS`, a requirement; each event-model screen, with its Allium surface, a user need
The tests	`tests/acceptance/`	each test claims the requirement it verifies with `@allure.tag("item-NN-SSS")`
This directory	`dhf/`	the documents below, and generated evidence

```
config.yml                          render configuration
documents/
  verification_and_validation_plan.md how RDM is verified and validated
  architecture.md                   the parts, the bounded contexts and the
dependency rule
  design/<context>.md               the design output of one bounded context
  document_control.md               git and GitHub as this record's document control
(DC-001, Part 11-mapped)
  tool_validation.md                RDM's final document (CSV-001, proposed): its
validation as a tool,
                                    with its architecture, risk policy and risks,
and its whole spec, rendered
  user_manual.md                    the IFU: the docs site's pages, in reading order
(IFU-001)
  traceability_matrix.md            the matrix template, rendered from generated
data, never hand-edited
decisions/
  adr-0002-…md                      RDM reads a spec as Gherkin and audits it
```

Generated, never committed (gitignored): `dhf/allure-results/` (the acceptance run) and `dhf/data/` (the verification data the matrix renders from).

Run the gates as CI does (`CLAUDE.md`):

```
uv run pytest tests/acceptance --clean-alluredir --alluredir=dhf/allure-results
uv run rdm story verify --dhf dhf --allure-results dhf/allure-results -o dhf/data/
verification.yml
uv run rdm story release-gate --dhf dhf --allure-results dhf/allure-results
uv run rdm graph validate --dhf dhf --allure-results dhf/allure-results
```

Trace a requirement, user need or risk with the `trace` tool of `rdm graph mcp` (registered in `.mcp.json`), or query the record with `rdm graph query`.

2 `docs/` and `dhf/`

`docs/` explains RDM to its users; `dhf/` is the record of how RDM itself is designed and verified.

	`docs/`	`dhf/`
What it is	RDM's instructions for use, plus an API reference generated from the docstrings	RDM's own design history file
Who it's for	People and agents using RDM on their own product	Whoever governs RDM's development: authors, reviewers, an auditor, and RDM's gates
Controlled?	Yes, as one document: IFU-001 lists its pages; each change is a reviewed pull request	Yes: each change is a reviewed pull request; the release gate requires every requirement verified
Checked by	`mkdocs build --strict`, and the tests of the IFU's own requirements	The release gate, `rdm graph validate`, `rdm gap`
Published	As the docs site, one copy per release	On the same site, each document as a page (and a PDF where Pandoc and Typst run), the spec one page per context, with the traceability matrix and map generated from a live test run

A product that adopts RDM gets its own `dhf/` (`rdm adopt` or `rdm init`), not RDM's.